

News Weekly

This chaotic 2,000-pound seal has returned to sea – but leaves behind a conundrum

Neil, the spirited young elephant seal, departed from Tasmania this week without so much as a wave of his flipper, leaving behind a trail of fans and questions regarding his future growth. Upon hearing about Neil's return in June, Rebecca Thomson rushed to the beach to catch a glimpse of him—one of the state's most renowned celebrities. Weighing an impressive 2,200 pounds, Neil made his way toward Thomson. "It's like a giant slug coming at you," she chuckled, maintaining a safe distance. "It was exciting, intriguing, and a bit intimidating, too."

Unlike many southern elephant seals that congregate on isolated islands, Neil seems to thrive on human interaction during his visits, often creating chaos by rocking vans, obstructing roads, and peering through doors. His playful antics have garnered a global fan base, inspired a theme song, and even led to appearances in local advertisements, solidifying his status as an icon. However, officials caution that his surging popularity could pose risks to his safety as he continues to grow.

(Science News)



Pluto has Landslides

Terrestrial planets are well-known for experiencing landslides, and similar occurrences have been observed on moons, asteroids, and comets. However, landslides had not been definitively identified on Pluto until recently. Analysis of New Horizons spacecraft images has revealed six substantial landslides on the dwarf planet, as reported by researchers in the journal *Icarus*. Combining a rocky landscape with gravity, landslides can significantly reshape environments by redistributing materials and nutrients, explains Maria Teresa Brunetti, a physicist specializing in landslides at the National Research Council in Italy.

Although bodies like Earth and Phobos show evidence of landslides, Pluto had been an exception. A reanalysis of New Horizons data identified six potential landslides near Sputnik Planitia. These landslides, located on impact crater rims, vary in size and height but travel longer distances due to lower friction. This discovery suggests that Pluto may host more landslides, warranting further data analysis and future missions.

(Science News)



Spain scores late goal to defeat Belgium 2-1, advances to meet France in semifinals

Spain's Mikel Merino scored the decisive goal in the 88th minute on Friday, leading Spain to a victory over Belgium and securing their spot in the World Cup semifinal. Spain will face France in Dallas on Tuesday, with a chance at the World Cup final at stake.

Spain's goals came after initial shots were saved, with deflections finding Spanish players who didn't miss. Fabián Ruiz scored first in the 30th minute when Thibaut Courtois failed to control a rebound. Courtois left the match with an injury in the 73rd minute, and Senne Lammens replaced him. Lammens managed to stop several attacks but conceded the go-ahead goal when Merino capitalized on a rebound from Paul Cubarsi's shot.

Spain coach Luis de la Fuente expressed determination: "We are here for more." Up next is France, a dominant team. "The game will be very demanding," de la Fuente noted. (Source: NBC News)



'It definitely worked!' Bear spray helps Lake Tahoe father fend off charging bear

A father from the Lake Tahoe area credits bear spray with stopping a charging bear after his daughters encountered it near their vacation home. Cortlandt Koerwitz explained that his daughters were packing coolers in the garage for a 4th of July boat trip when they spotted a bear rummaging through garbage. "Instead of running away, the bear came toward them," Koerwitz said. He grabbed the bear spray he keeps by the garage door as the bear approached. "It was rushing me," he recalled. "The spray worked, although some blew back on me." Video footage shows Koerwitz using the spray as the bear advanced, resulting in him coughing and saying, "Got to get a mask on." Despite frequent bear sightings, this was the first aggressive encounter he experienced.

(Source: ABC)



Tiny bubbles could revolutionize inkjet printing

Researchers at Tokyo Metropolitan University have pioneered a new technique to manage ink drying by incorporating ultra-fine bubbles into ink droplets, eliminating the need for chemical additives. By adjusting the number of bubbles in each droplet, they discovered they could significantly influence the pattern left as the liquid evaporates. This innovation is particularly beneficial for manufacturing tiny electronic devices, where residual additives can disrupt the performance of printed materials.

Inkjet printing, once reserved for documents and images, is now vital for producing advanced technologies like microelectronics and MEMS, which require precise deposition of microscopic coatings and intricate circuit patterns. A key challenge lies in controlling the drying process of droplets to prevent uneven particle distribution, such as the "coffee ring" effect, where solids gather at the droplet's edges.

Instead of using chemical surfactants, Professor Arata Kaneko's team dispersed nanoscale ultra-fine bubbles in the liquid. Their experiments demonstrated that varying bubble concentration allowed for control over the particle pattern, resulting in more uniform coatings.



Jokes

What is a cat magician called?

The Great Meowdini.

Horsle



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		4		5	
	4	2	1	3	
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4	1		2	6	
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Steak Gaucho-Style with Argentinian Chimichurri Sauce

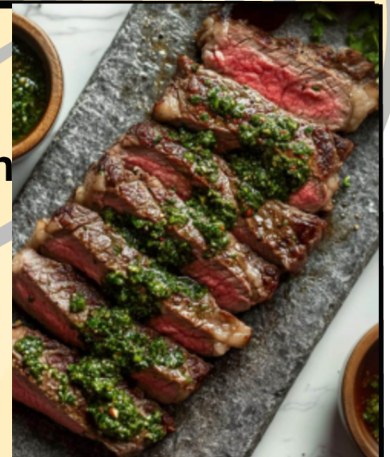
Instructions

Make the Chimmichurri

- Add parsley, garlic, oregano, chili flakes, salt, and pepper to a bowl.
- Pour in olive oil and vinegar.
- Stir well and let sit at least 1 hour minutes.
- Taste and adjust salt, vinegar, or chili as needed.

For the Steak

- Season the steak with salt, pepper, and chili flakes. Rub with olive oil.
- 1. Heat your grill or pan to high heat.
- 2. Cook the steak 3–5 minutes per side for medium-rare, or longer for preferred doneness.
- 3. Rest the steak for 5–10 minutes before slicing.
- 4. Serve with chimichurri spooned over the top.



Ingredients

For the steak

- 1–2 ribeye, sirloin, or strip steaks (about 1–1.5 inches thick)
- 1 tbsp salt
- 1 tsp black pepper
- 1 tsp chili flakes or cayenne (optional)

For the Chimmichurri

- 1 cup fresh parsley, finely chopped
- 3–4 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 tsp dried oregano
- ½ tsp chili flakes
- ½ cup olive oil
- 2 tbsp lemon juice
- ½ tsp salt
- ¼ tsp black pepper